QuietTime

User Guide

Simple screen time control that respects your family's privacy.

No accounts • No cloud • No tracking • No ads

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1. Welcome

QuietTime is a screen time management app designed for families. It lets parents set bedtime schedules that automatically lock a child's device during quiet hours, replacing the home screen with a beautiful animated block screen.

Unlike other parental control apps, QuietTime is completely private. There are no accounts to create, no cloud servers, no analytics, no tracking, and no ads. Everything runs locally on the device. Your family's data never leaves the phone or computer.

QuietTime is available for Android and Windows, with a one-time purchase price — no subscriptions, no in-app purchases.

2. Getting Started

Installation

- **Android** — Download QuietTime from Google Play. The app requires Android 8.0 or later.
- **Windows** — Download QuietTime from the Microsoft Store. Requires Windows 10 or later.

Setting Your PIN

When you first open QuietTime, you'll be asked to create a 6-digit PIN. This PIN protects all settings and prevents children from changing the schedule or disabling the app. Choose something memorable but not easy for your child to guess.

Tip: Write your PIN down somewhere safe. If you forget it, you'll need to reinstall the app to reset it.

Granting Permissions (Android)

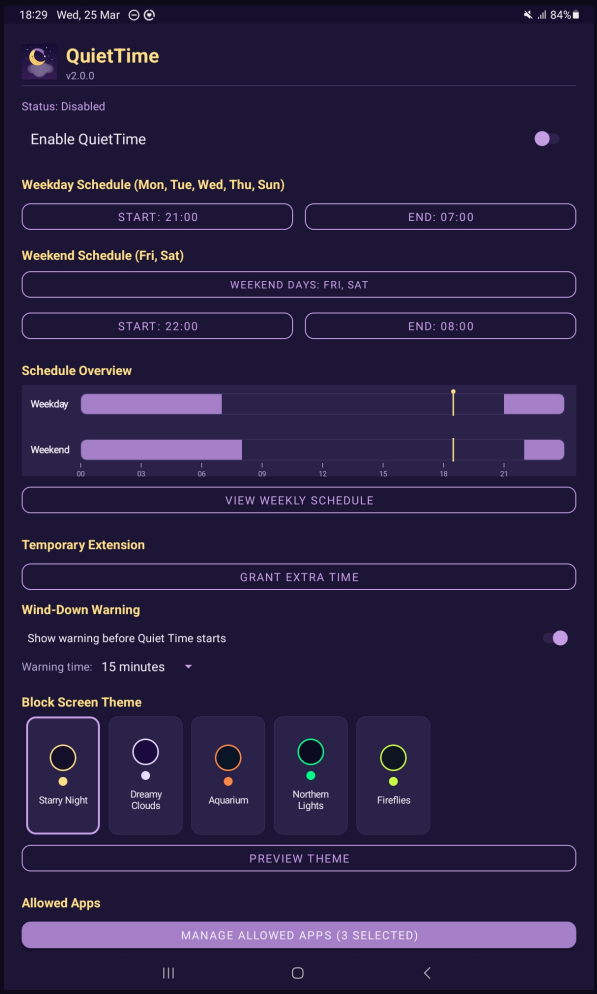
On Android, QuietTime needs two permissions to work properly:

- **Display over other apps** — Allows the block screen to appear on top of other apps.
- **Accessibility service** — Keeps the block screen active and prevents children from dismissing it.

The app will guide you through enabling these on first launch. You can check their status at any time using the Check Permissions button in settings.

3. The Dashboard

The dashboard is your main control centre. After entering your PIN, you'll see all settings on a single scrollable screen.



The QuietTime dashboard — all settings at a glance.

Enable QuietTime

The toggle at the top turns QuietTime on or off. When enabled, the app will automatically lock the device during your scheduled quiet hours. The status bar shows whether QuietTime is currently active or waiting for the next scheduled period.

Weekday Schedule

Set the start and end times for school nights. For example, 21:00 to 07:00 means the device locks at 9pm and unlocks at 7am. The days shown (e.g. Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Sun) are based on your weekend day selection.

Weekend Schedule

Set different times for weekends — perhaps a later bedtime (22:00) and later wake-up (08:00). Use the Weekend Days selector to choose which days count as weekends. The default is Friday and Saturday nights, but you can adjust this to match your routine.

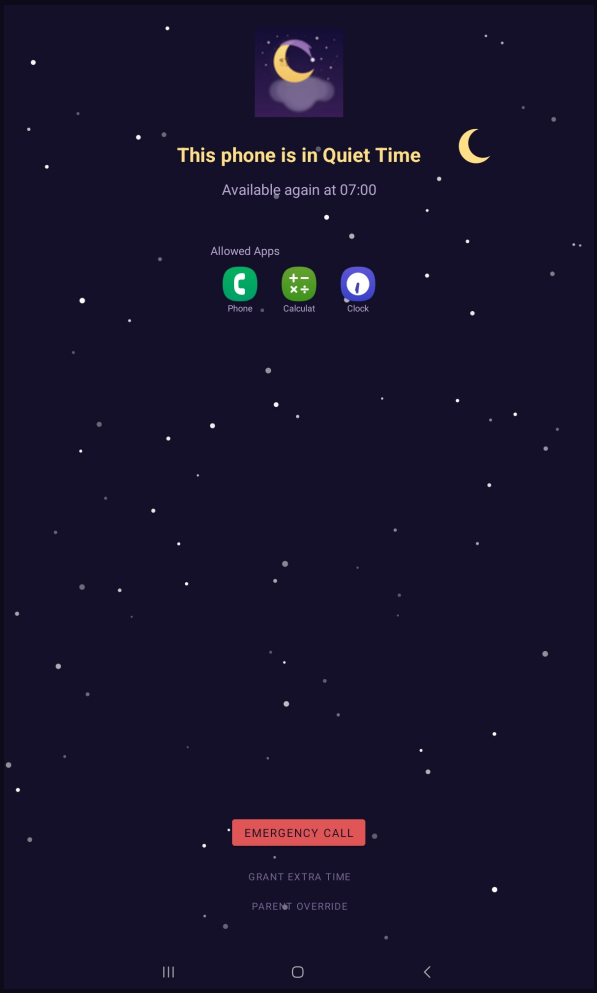
Schedule Overview

The visual timeline shows your weekday and weekend schedules as coloured bars, giving you a quick overview of when the device will be locked. Tap View Weekly Schedule to see the full week laid out.

4. Block Screen Themes

When quiet time starts, the device displays a full-screen animated block screen. Rather than a harsh lockout message, children see a calming, beautiful animation. There are five themes to choose from:

- **Starry Night** — Twinkling stars on a deep night sky with a crescent moon.
- **Dreamy Clouds** — Soft, drifting clouds in pastel colours.
- **Aquarium** — Colourful fish swimming gently across the screen.
- **Northern Lights** — Shimmering aurora borealis effect.
- **Fireflies** — Glowing fireflies floating through a twilight scene.



The Starry Night block screen with allowed apps and emergency call.

Use the Preview Theme button on the dashboard to see each animation before choosing. You can change the theme at any time.

5. Allowed Apps

You can choose which apps remain accessible during quiet time. These apps are displayed as icons on the block screen so your child can open them without needing to unlock the device.

Common choices include:

- **Phone** — So your child can make and receive calls.
- **Clock / Alarm** — For morning alarms.
- **Calculator** — For homework.

Tap Manage Allowed Apps on the dashboard to see the full list of installed apps and toggle which ones are permitted. The number of currently selected apps is shown on the button (e.g. "3 Selected").

Tip: Keep the allowed list short. The fewer apps available during quiet time, the more effective the schedule will be.

6. Wind-Down Warnings

Nobody likes being cut off mid-game. Wind-down warnings send a gentle notification before quiet time starts, giving your child time to save their progress and get ready for bed.

To enable wind-down warnings, toggle the switch on the dashboard and choose a warning time. Options range from 1 to 30 minutes before the scheduled block time.

The notification will say something like "Quiet Time starts in 15 minutes" — a calm reminder rather than a sudden lockout.

7. Parent Controls

Life isn’t always on a schedule. QuietTime gives you three ways to override the lock when needed:

Grant Extra Time

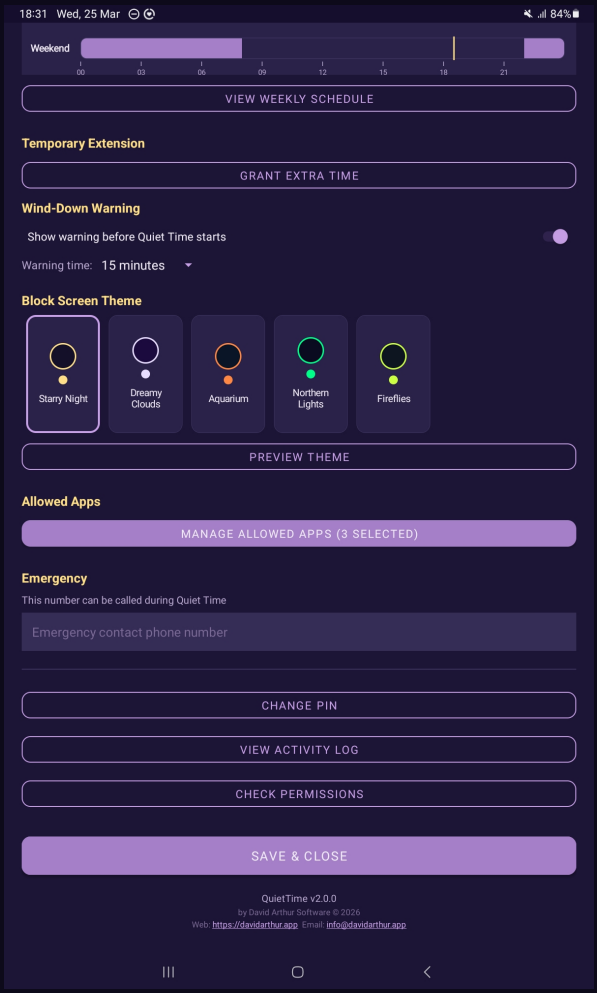
Available right from the block screen. Tap Grant Extra Time, enter your PIN, and choose 15, 30, or 60 minutes of additional screen time. The device will lock again automatically when the extension expires.

Parent Override

Need to fully unlock the device? Tap Parent Override on the block screen and enter your PIN. The device will be unlocked until the next scheduled quiet period begins.

Lock Now

Want to start quiet time early? The Lock Now button on the dashboard immediately activates the block screen, regardless of the schedule. Useful when it’s been a long day and bedtime needs to come a bit sooner.



Parent tools: emergency contact, PIN change, and permissions.

8. Emergency Access

Safety always comes first. The Emergency Call button is always visible at the bottom of the block screen, even during quiet time. Your child can tap it to call emergency services without needing a PIN.

You can also set an optional emergency contact phone number in settings. This allows your child to call a specific person (a parent, grandparent, or trusted adult) during quiet time without unlocking the device.

Tip: Set the emergency contact to your own mobile number so your child can always reach you, even when the device is locked.

9. Changing Your PIN

If you need to change your PIN — perhaps your child has seen you enter it — scroll to the bottom of the dashboard and tap Change PIN. You'll need to enter your current PIN first, then choose a new 6-digit code and confirm it.

10. Windows Features

The Windows version of QuietTime includes the same scheduling, themes, and parent controls as Android, plus a few desktop-specific features:

Three Lock Levels

- **Gentle** — A dismissable warning overlay. Best for older teens who need a reminder rather than a hard block.
- **Standard** — A fullscreen overlay that covers the desktop. Cannot be closed without the PIN.
- **Strict** — Locks the Windows workstation entirely (like pressing Win+L). The child must enter the Windows password to unlock, but QuietTime will re-lock the screen if quiet time is still active.

Auto-Start

Enable the "Start with Windows" option to ensure QuietTime runs automatically when the computer starts. This prevents children from bypassing quiet time by restarting the PC.

11. Privacy

QuietTime was designed with one simple principle: your family's data is yours and yours alone.

- **No accounts** — No sign-up, no email, no password.
- **No cloud** — Nothing is ever sent to a server.
- **No analytics** — No usage tracking, no telemetry, no crash reports.
- **No ads** — No advertisements of any kind, ever.
- **No internet required** — Works completely offline.

All settings and schedules are stored locally on the device. If you uninstall QuietTime, all data is removed with it. There is nothing to delete from any server because nothing was ever sent.

Read the full privacy policy at davidarthur.app/quiettime/privacy/

12. Troubleshooting

Q: Can my child bypass the lock screen?

On Android, QuietTime uses accessibility and overlay permissions to stay on top of all other apps. Children cannot dismiss, close, or swipe away the block screen without the parent PIN. On Windows, Strict mode locks the entire workstation. If you find the block screen is not appearing, check that the required permissions are still enabled using the Check Permissions button in settings.

Q: What if there’s an emergency?

The Emergency Call button is always visible on the block screen. Tapping it opens the phone dialler to call emergency services. You can also configure an emergency contact number so your child can reach a trusted adult during quiet time.

Q: Does QuietTime need an internet connection?

No. QuietTime works entirely offline. There are no servers, accounts, or cloud features. The app runs completely on the device.

Q: What happens if the device restarts?

On Android, QuietTime automatically restarts when the device boots. On Windows, enable the "Start with Windows" option to ensure it runs after a restart.

Q: I forgot my PIN. What do I do?

Unfortunately, there is no PIN recovery option — this is by design, to prevent children from resetting it. You will need to uninstall and reinstall the app, which will reset all settings. We recommend writing your PIN down somewhere safe.

Q: How do I uninstall QuietTime?

On Android, you may need to disable the accessibility service first in your device settings (Settings > Accessibility > QuietTime > Off), then uninstall normally from the app drawer or Google Play. On Windows, uninstall from Settings > Apps.

Q: Can I use QuietTime on multiple devices?

Yes. Each device runs independently — there is no account linking or cloud sync. Purchase the app on each device’s store and configure the schedule separately.

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